

**UNIT
6**

**EXPRESSIONS
SIMILAR TO
MODAL VERBS**

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1. "Be supposed to" + Infinitive

- This means "**should**" or "**ought to**" but expresses the idea that someone else expects something to be done.

Examples:

- I'm supposed to attend the seminar. (The manager expects me to do so.)
- I should attend the seminar. (It's a good idea because I might get some useful information.)

2. "Be to" + Infinitive

- This means "**must**" but expresses the idea that someone else demands something.

Examples:

- I am to get to the airport before 9.00. (My boss has told me to go there, so I can't avoid it.)
- I must get to the airport before 9.00. (If I don't go there, there will be no one to meet the person arriving tonight.)

3. Expectations Using "Be supposed to" and "Be to"

- Both can express what someone expects about a previously arranged event.

Examples:

- The conference is supposed to/is to start tomorrow. (It is scheduled.)

4. "Be likely to" + Infinitive

- This means "**may**" or "**might**" and expresses possibility. In questions, we don't use "**may**" for this purpose; instead, we use:

Examples:

- Is he likely to win the race?
- Is it likely that he will win the race?
- Could he win the race?

5. "Would you mind + verb 1st form + ing"

- Used to express polite, formal requests.

Examples:

- Would you mind lending me a hand?

6. Making Suggestions

- Use expressions like **"Let's," "How about," "Why don't we," "What about."**

Examples:

- Let's go for a ride.
- How about going for a ride?
- Why don't we go for a ride?
- What about going for a ride?

7. Offering Help

- Use **"Would you like to/Would you like me to..."** or **"Shall I..."** to offer help.

Examples:

- Would you like me to pick up your laundry? (Shall I pick up your laundry?)

8. Expressing Permission

- Use **"Be allowed to"** to talk about permission or rules.

Examples:

- He was allowed to cross the border. (NOT: He could cross.)
- Was he allowed to enter the building?

EXERCISES

Exercise: 1

How else can you express the following?

1. Can I have the last cake, please?

2. Let's go for a bike ride.

3. She might be on holiday.

4. Could you hold this for me, please?

5. You can't take photos in here.

6. I've been ordered to wait outside the classroom.

7. Shall we go to the basketball match?

8. How about inviting Sarah and Sofia?

9. Is it possible that he will be offered the job soon?

10. Would you mind moving your car, please?

11. Would you like me to make lunch?

12. You are expected to be here on time.

Exercise: 2

Fill in the blanks with a modal or synonymous expression and the appropriate form of the verbs in brackets.

1. I'm gaining weight. I really _____ (try) to go on a diet, like the doctor said.

2. What a lovely day! _____ (we/go) for a walk?

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3. I'm not sure where Gary is. He _____ (be) at the library.
 4. That _____ (not/be) Ali's car. He doesn't own one.
 5. Zain _____ (sleep) but I'm not sure. Why don't you go and see?
 6. Don't worry. You _____ (not/dress) formally for the party.
 7. If you wanted to borrow my car, you _____ (ask) me.
 8. This dog _____ (belong) to Harry. It's got his address on its collar.

Exercise: 3

Choose the most appropriate response.

1. Would you mind posting this letter for me?
 - a) Yes, you may.
 - b) Not at all.

2. We could order a pizza tonight.
 - a) That's a good idea.
 - b) No, we might not.

3. Can I borrow your pen, please?
 - a) Not at all.
 - b) Of course.

4. Shall I open the window?
 - a) No, you won't.
 - b) No, it's okay, thanks.

5. Will you help me with the laundry, please?

a) Yes, I may.

b) Certainly.

6. Could you pick me up at the train station, please?

a) No, you couldn't.

b) Yes, of course.

7. Would you please reply to these emails?

a) I'd be happy to.

b) Yes, I would.

8. Can I park here?

a) No, you can't.

b) No, thank you.

Exercise: 4

Rephrase the following sentences in as many ways as possible.

1. I advise you to see a doctor.

2. It isn't necessary for him to buy her a present.

3. I'm sure Zain isn't at football practice.

4. It is possible that Lisa will go to the party tonight.

5. You aren't allowed to make noise at night.

6. We are obliged to wear a uniform at work.

7. Would you like me to carry your luggage?

8. How about getting a part-time job?

9. It's forbidden to park here.

10. Sami managed to pass his driving test.

Exercise: 5

Complete the email using modal verbs.

Dear Sarah,

I'm sorry to hear about your problem, but there are so many things you can do to make your life better. You shouldn't feel guilty about your situation.

Best wishes,
Sofia